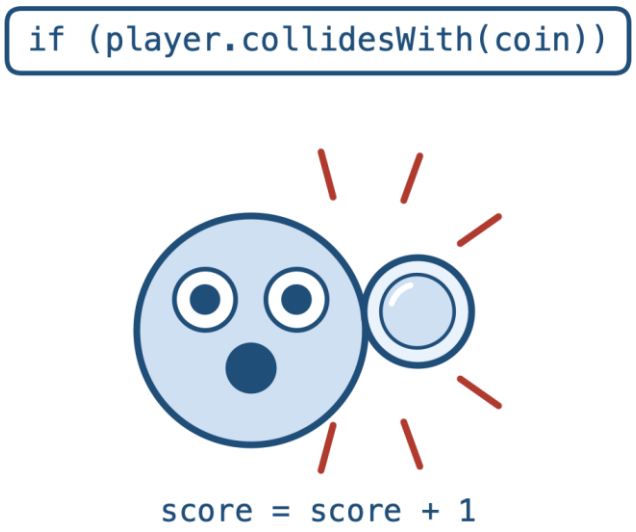
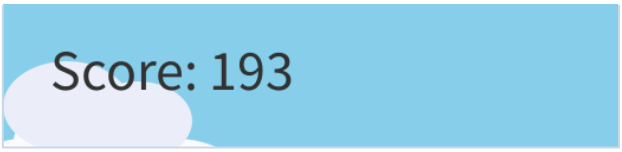
Chapter 6 - Collisions: If This, Then That

Things finally touch each other, and your program decides what happens next. This is where it becomes a game.



One coin. A few seconds. A very good score.




```
if (player.collidesWith(coin)) {
  score = score + 1;   // add a point
}
```

Chapter 5 ended with a coin drifting through your world, and touching it does nothing. What *should* happen?

Today your sketch starts paying attention. Touch the coin, and you score a point. Touch something dangerous, and the game ends.

The new idea is `if`: making something happen only when it's true. The library can tell when two things are touching, and that gives `if` something to be true about.

This chapter takes two meetings, and does it in four moves.

Part	The idea
One	**Are they touching?** A yes-or-no question, and an `if` to act on the answer.
Two	**Keep score.** A number that remembers, on the screen, one point per touch.
Three	**A game that can end.** A hazard, a true-or-false, and two screens.
Four	**Make it yours.** Harder, easier, and yours.

Parts One and Two are the first meeting. Parts Three and Four are the second.

Today's example. This chapter has one for each meeting. Before you start, open the first: **File → Examples**, then **Contributed Libraries → SpriteGame → Lessons → Lesson06_Collisions_Day1**. Run it, and the stand-in character chases your mouse. Steer it onto the coin: the score in the corner goes up, and the coin jumps somewhere new. That's where the first meeting ends up. Keep its window open, and when your sketch does something strange, compare the two. Your own work goes in your own sketch. Appendix 1, section A1.6, walks through opening an example one click at a time.

Ask Sparky. This lesson's Sparky opens from the button on the Lesson 6 page on Canvas. Good things to ask it: "my score goes up way too fast," "my score will not show up on screen," "what is the difference between = and ==?", or "how do I add a second hazard?" If something won't run, paste in your `draw()` or `playGame()`.

Part One - Are they touching?

6.1 A yes-or-no question

```
player.collidesWith(coin)
```

`collidesWith()` asks one question: *are these two touching?* The library checks whether their circles overlap, and hands back `true` or `false`.

Your character has `collidesWith()` because you wrote `class MyCharacter extends Blob` back in Chapter 2. It's one of the things a Blob can do, so your character got it for free.

Remember the `30` in your `super(...)` line? In Chapter 2 you changed it, and nothing on the screen changed. This is what it's for. That number is the radius of an invisible circle around your character, called its **hitbox**, and `collidesWith()` uses that circle and only that circle. Your drawing can be any size you like.

6.2 `if`

An `if` makes something happen only when a question's answer is yes:

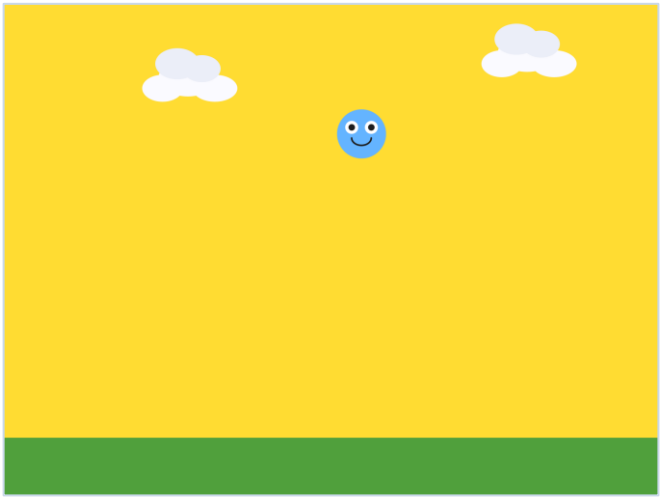
```
if (player.collidesWith(coin)) {
  background(255, 220, 50);   // only happens while they are touching
}
```

- The part in the parentheses is the **condition**, the yes-or-no question.
- The part in the braces is what happens when the condition is true.
- When it's false, Processing skips straight past the braces.

Step 1 - The gold flash

Build it. Open your sketch from Chapter 5. In `draw()`, right after your `background()` line, add the `if` above. Run it, and touch the coin.

> **Check.** The sky flashes gold while you touch the coin, and goes back to blue when you let go.



Touching the coin.

`draw()` runs sixty times a second, so it asks *are they touching?* sixty times a second. On every frame where the answer is yes, the sky is gold.

Step 2 - Generous or precise

Your turn. If touching the coin feels too hard or too easy, open your `MyCharacter` tab and change the radius in the `super(...)` line. A bigger radius touches things from further away, which feels generous. A smaller one means you have to be right on top of something, which feels precise. Which do you want your game to be?

Part Two - Keep score

Step 3 - A number that remembers

Build it. Delete the gold flash. Then, at the very top of your sketch, next to your other variables, add:

```
int score = 0;      // a whole number, starts at zero
```

> **Aside: `int`**
>
> `int` is the kind of variable that holds a whole number: `0`, `7`, `-3`. No decimal point. In one line, `int score = 0;` makes a box called `score` and puts a `0` in it.

A score has to remember something from one frame to the next. So it goes at the very **top** of your sketch, outside `setup()` and outside `draw()`. Up there, every function in your sketch can see it.

> **Watch out.** Put `int score = 0;` inside `setup()`, and the box only exists while `setup()` runs. `draw()` can't see it, and the sketch stops with:
>
> ```
> score cannot be resolved to a variable
> ```
>
> Move it back to the top.

Step 4 - The score on the screen

Build it. At the bottom of `draw()`, add three lines:

```
fill(50);                          // the text color
textSize(24);                      // how big
text("Score: " + score, 20, 36);   // what, then x, then y
```

Run it.

Check. `Score: 0` in the top-left corner.



The score.

Aside: `text()`

`text()` draws words on the screen. You give it what to say, then where: x, then y. The `+` glues the words `"Score: "` and the number in `score` together into one piece of text. Set `fill()` **before** `text()`, or your words come out in whatever color the last shape used.

Build it. Test it by cheating. Change `int score = 0;` to `int score = 7;`, and run.

Check. `Score: 7`.



The cheat.

Setting a value by hand to check that the display works is a real technique. Programmers do it all the time. Set it back to `0`.

Step 5 - A point per touch

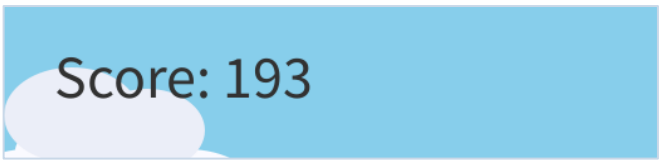
Build it. Above the three score lines, add the collision `if` again, this time with a point inside:

```
if (player.collidesWith(coin)) {
  score = score + 1;   // add a point
}
```

> **Aside:** `score = score + 1`
>
> Read it right to left. Take what's in `score`, add one, and put the answer back in `score`. The `=` means *make this equal to that*.

Run it, and sit your player on the coin. Watch the score.

> **Check.** The score races upward, as long as you're touching the coin.



A few seconds of touching.

Why is it doing that? Make a guess before you read on.

`draw()` asks *are they touching?* every frame. For as long as you sit on the coin, the answer is yes, and every yes is a point. That's a point for every frame: sixty a second, if you sit right on it.

Step 6 - One touch, one point

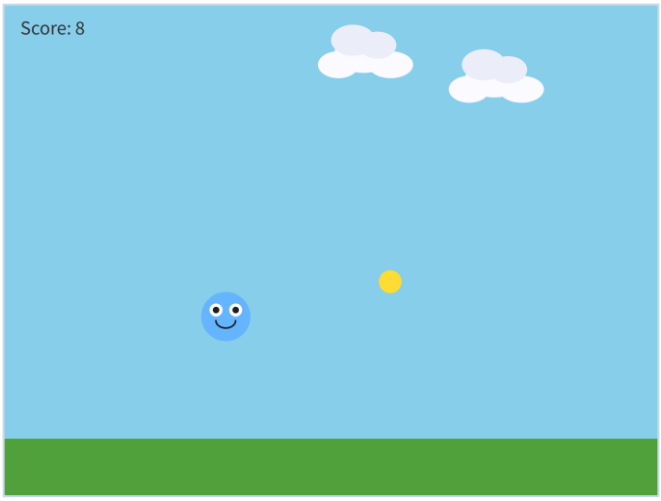
The fix is to end the touch the moment you count it. Move the coin somewhere else.

Build it. Inside the same `if`, after the point, add:

```
coin.moveTo(random(width), random(100, height - 150));  // coin jumps somewhere new
```

Run it.

Check. Touch the coin, and you score one point, and the coin jumps somewhere new.



Eight coins in fifteen seconds.

You met `moveTo()` in Chapter 4, teleporting your character to a click. Here it teleports the coin, and `random()` picks the spot, so it lands somewhere new every time.

Your turn. Change the coin's speed and size, and style the score so it fits your world. The score's `fill()` and `textSize()` are yours.